

Our Universe - Solar System and The Moon (Part - 4)

Other Heavenly Bodies

Asteroid:



Fig: Asteroid

Large number of small bodies that fills the gap between the orbits of the Mars and Jupiter and revolve around the Sun like other planets. Asteroids are called as minor planets because it has its own orbit and its size varies from kilometer to few hundred kilometers. About 3500 asteroids are orbiting the Sun.

Comets

Meteors and Meteorites

Commonly Asked Questions:

1. Which one of the following statements is correct?

- (a) Asteroids are the part of our solar system
- (b) Asteroids are not the part of our solar system
- (c) Asteroids are the satellites of planet saturn
- (d) Asteroids are the satellites of planet venus
- (e) None of these

Answer: (a)

Explanation

Asteroids are the part of our solar system. Therefore, option (A) is correct and rest of the options is incorrect,

2. Which one of the following statements is correct about comet?

- (a) Comet revolves around the sun
- (b) Comet is a part of our solar system
- (c) A comet has many moon

- (d) Both A and B
(e) None of these

Answer: (d)

Explanation

Comets are part of our solar system which revolves around the sun. Therefore, option (D) is correct and rest of the options is incorrect.

Constellation

If we see night sky, we find certain patterns of stars resembling living creatures or inanimate objects. Such groups of stars are called as constellation. Each constellation is named after their resemblance with specific things. For example Orion is a group of stars resembling a hunter (Orion means hunter).



Fig: A Group of stars (Constellation)

Constellations are not real

Name of the constellation	Shape	When visible in the sky
Orion	Hunter	Winter
The Big Dipper	Ladle	Early in the morning and early in the evening all year round
Ursa major (great bear)	Plough	Throughout the year
Ursa minor (Little dipper)	Ladle	Throughout the year

The star at the end of the dipper handle is pole star. It is the brightest star in the constellation.

Pole star is called as Polaris. It lies on the earth's axis of rotation and hence its apparent position doesn't seem to change. It looks exactly over our head when seen from the poles.

Commonly Asked Questions

1. The cause of the extinction of the dinosaurs could be.

- (a) Collision of asteroids
- (b) Collision of meteors
- (c) Collision of meteorites
- (d) Collision of comets
- (e) None of these

Answer: (a)

Explanation

Many scientists believe that asteroid collided with our planet. As a result huge amount of dust was released that might had covered the Earth's surface, cutting off sunlight for long periods of time. These finally led to extinction of many species including dinosaurs from the Earth. Therefore, option (A) is correct and rest of the options is incorrect.

Space Mission

A young Russian pilot named Yuri Gagarin became the first person to orbit around the earth in a small capsule called vostok 1.

Valentina Tereshkova was the first woman to go into space in vostok 6 In 1963.

Sally Ride, the first American woman to go in space in 1983.

A lexel Leonov took 10 minutes space work on 18" march 1965 in vostok 2.

Neil Armstrong was the first person to step on the moon in Apollo 11 with Edwin Aldrin

Laika, a dog was the first living organism who spent seven days in space in sputnik 2.

Commonly Asked Questions

Which was the first manned satellite to orbit the earth?

- (a) Vostok 1
- (b) Sputnik 2
- (c) Vostok 6
- (d) Sputnik 1
- (e) Apollo 11

Answer: (a)

Explanation Vostok 1 was the first manned satellite to orbit the earth. It was launched by Russia on 12 April 1961- Therefore, option (A) is correct and rest of the options is incorrect.

Which of the two astronauts accompanied Neil Armstrong to land on to the moon's surface in 1969?

- (a) Michael Collins, James Irwin
- (b) David scot. Buzz Aldrin
- (c) Edwin Aldrin, Michael Collins
- (d) Alexi leonov, David scot
- (e) James Irwin, David scot

Answer: (C)

Explanation

Edwin Aldrin and Michael Collins accompanied the Neil Armstrong who made the first manned landing on the lunar surface, iames Irwin and David scot drove the battery powered buggy over the moon's surface.

Therefore, option (C) is correct and rest of the options is incorrect.

You Must Know



1. Ham (the chimpanzee) and alike (dog) were just 2 animals out of many who travelled into space.
2. There are 3 space shuttles in use today Discovery, Atlantic and Endeavour.
3. Challenger exploded in 1986 and Columbia shuttle exploded on entering the earth's surface. Kalpana chawla was one of the astronauts who died in that tragedy.
4. To escape from earth's gravity rocket has to gain speed of about 40,000 kmph.